

LOTUS PERFORMANCE CARS

Card Sorting Research

Assignment 2 · UX-205 Information Design

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“Can users confidently place Lotus model, comparison, purchase, ownership, and brand-content pages into the proposed navigation categories?”

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The short version

Five participants completed a closed card sort of 20 Lotus website pages into 5 proposed categories on UXtweak (October 15-16, 2026). Agreement was low: **no card was placed unanimously**, and 15 of 20 cards peaked at 2-of-5 agreement. The single clear consensus - ***Handbooks & manuals* into *Owners* (4/5)** - validates an ownership-support hub. Everything else remains a working hypothesis, not a validated structure.

Key takeaways

1. **One real consensus: *Handbooks & manuals* → *Owners* (4/5).** Why it matters: the ownership hub proposed in Assignment 1 is the only grouping users confirmed. Build the IA around it.
2. **Zero unanimous placements; 15 of 20 cards scattered at 2/5.** Why it matters: most category labels lack scent for most content. Treat the proposed IA as a hypothesis to test, not a finding.
3. **The Compare category failed its own test** - *Compare models* reached *Compare* only 1/5. Why it matters: it challenges the Assignment 1 “compare-before-configuring” flow; comparison may belong inside model pages instead.
4. **Purchase steps never settled** - *Configure your Lotus*, *Prices & offers* and *Available cars* peaked at 2/5 across three or four categories. Why it matters: the buy journey needs stronger step labels before anything is built.
5. **Sessions ran 50-86 seconds - fast and low-deliberation.** Why it matters: these findings are directional. A slower, deliberate retest is needed before finalizing the IA.

Bottom line: keep the five categories as a working structure, fix *Contact us* as a global utility, add the cross-links listed in the action plan, and retest - especially Compare and the purchase steps.

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01 · RESEARCH OBJECTIVE

What we set out to test

The objective is to test whether the proposed top-level labels - **Models, Compare, Buy & test drive, Owners,** and **Lotus story** - match how prospective users expect Lotus website content to be grouped. The study is designed to identify clear placements, ambiguous labels, and pages that may need a different parent category.

Research questions

1. Which cards receive consistent placements across all five participants?
2. Which cards split between two or more categories?
3. Do action-oriented pages such as *Configure your Lotus* and *Book a test drive* belong together in participants' mental models?
4. Do ownership-support pages form a coherent *Owners* category?
5. Are comparison tools understood as a distinct category rather than part of *Models* or *Buy & test drive*?



A Lotus retail store - the physical counterpart to the website experience under test.

02 · METHOD

Why card sorting

Card sorting is a user-experience research method in which participants organize labeled content items into groups that make sense to them. The patterns help a designer understand users' mental models and make evidence-informed information architecture decisions [1].

Open	Closed	Hybrid
Create and name groups	Use predefined groups	Use or add groups
Best for discovering a structure.	*Best for validating categories.*	*Best for refining with flexibility.*

A **closed** sort is appropriate because the design already has five candidate top-level categories. The purpose is not to generate an entirely new taxonomy; it is to see whether users can place Lotus content into the proposed groups consistently and to identify labels that require revision [2].

03 · STUDY DESIGN

How the study ran

Format	Remote, unmoderated, closed
Tool	UXtweak
Cards	20 page / content labels
Categories	5 predefined groups
Responses	7 total - 5 completed, 2 abandoned (excluded)
Study link	study.uxtweak.com/cardsort/pEO55WnoaI6cotMVRKNq2

Participant instructions

1. Open the live UXtweak link on a desktop browser.
2. Read the study introduction and review all five categories.
3. Drag every card into the category that feels most appropriate.
4. Use personal judgment; there is no single correct answer.
5. Finish the sort and confirm completion before closing the browser.

Study setup evidence

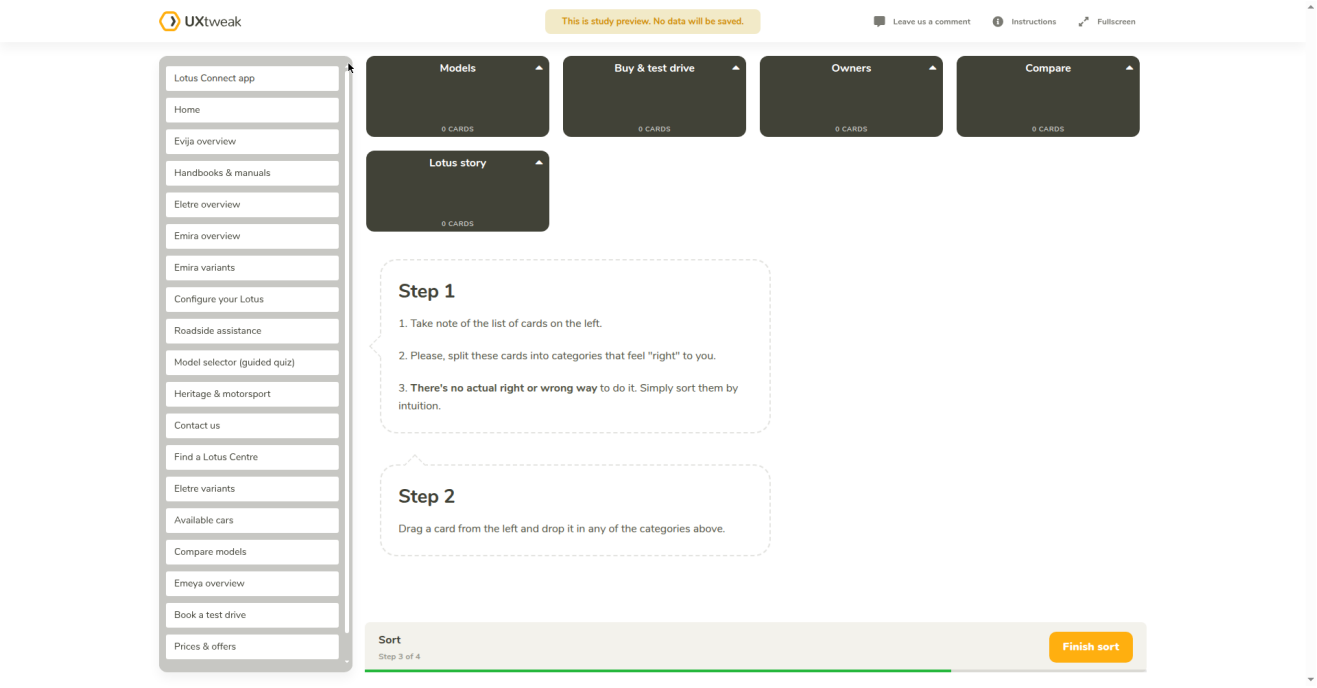


Figure 1 - The 20 configured cards in the UXtweak study setup.

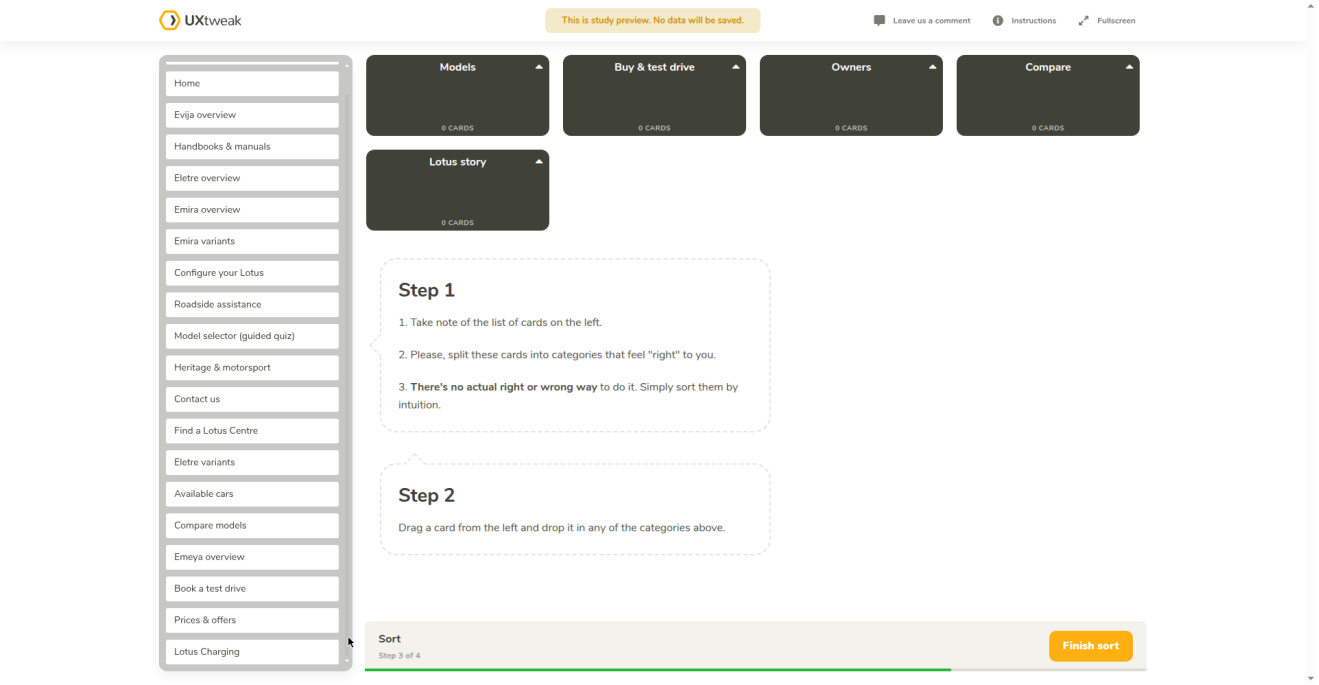


Figure 2 - The 5 predefined categories in the UXtweak study setup.

04 · CARD SET

The 20 cards, at a glance



The Emira - the heart of the Models category.

· 01 Home	· 02 Emira overview
· 03 Emira variants	· 04 Eletre overview
· 05 Eletre variants	· 06 Emeya overview
· 07 Evija overview	· 08 Compare models
· 09 Model selector (guided quiz)	· 10 Configure your Lotus
· 11 Prices & offers	· 12 Available cars
· 13 Book a test drive	· 14 Find a Lotus Centre
· 15 Lotus Charging	· 16 Lotus Connect app
· 17 Handbooks & manuals	· 18 Roadside assistance
· 19 Contact us	· 20 Heritage & motorsport

The five categories

Models - vehicle model and variant information.

Compare - side-by-side comparison and model-selection guidance.

Buy & test drive - configuration, prices, inventory, test drives, and retail locations.

Owners - charging, connected services, manuals, assistance, and contact support.

Lotus story - heritage, motorsport, and brand narrative.

05 · PARTICIPANTS

Five completed sorts

Participants were recruited through the live UXtweak study link and completed the sort independently. Profiles are anonymized; completion timestamps and placement distributions are used to interpret variation.

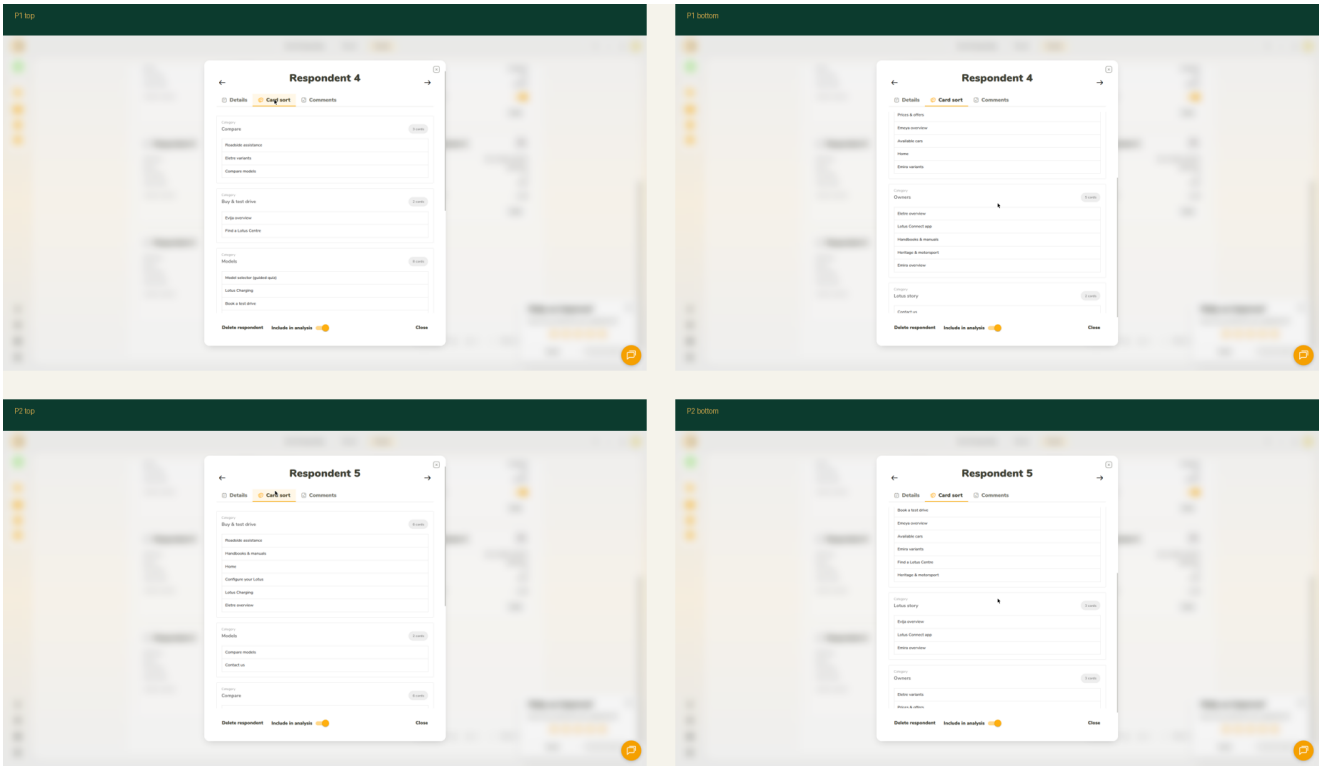
P1 (Respondent 4) - completed Oct 15, 10:34 PM, 1m 26s - placed 8 of 20 cards in Models, the heaviest Models user.

P2 (Respondent 5) - completed Oct 15, 10:36 PM, 1m 25s - split 6 Buy & test drive / 6 Compare.

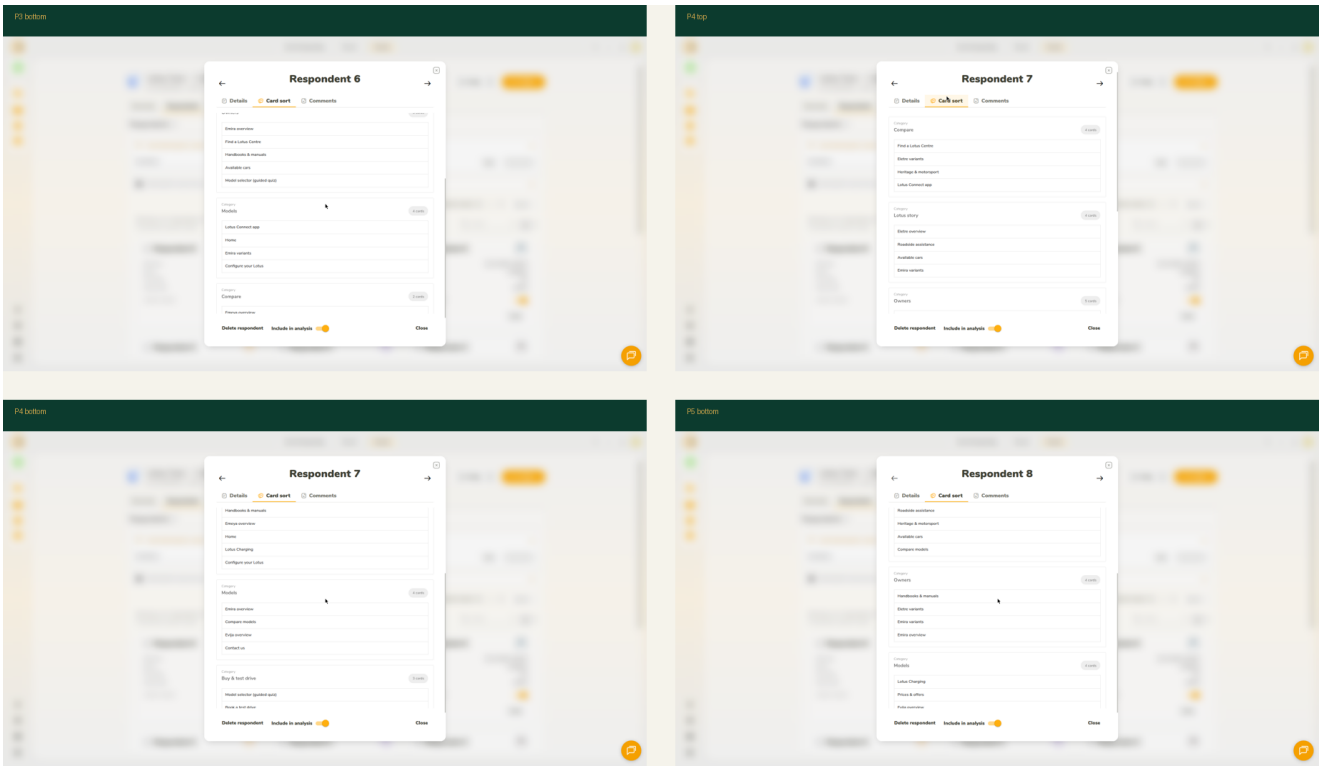
P3 (Respondent 6) - completed Oct 16, 12:58 PM, 53s - spread 5 Buy & test drive / 5 Owners.

P4 (Respondent 7) - completed Oct 16, 12:59 PM - leaned Owners (5 of 20).

P5 (Respondent 8) - completed Oct 16, 1:52 PM, 50s - perfectly even: 4 cards in each category.



Figures 3–4 - P1 and P2 completed sorts (UXtweak result view).



Figures 5–6 - P3, P4 and P5 completed sorts (UXtweak result view).

Data-quality note: recorded times of 50–86 seconds for a 20-card sort suggest participants moved quickly; findings are treated as directional.

Placement matrix - 100 decisions

Key: **M** = Models · **C** = Compare · **B** = Buy & test drive · **O** = Owners · **S** = Lotus story

Card	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5
Home	**M**	**B**	**M**	**O**	**B**
Emira overview	**O**	**S**	**O**	**M**	**O**
Emira variants	**M**	**C**	**M**	**S**	**O**
Eletre overview	**O**	**B**	**B**	**S**	**C**
Eletre variants	**C**	**O**	**S**	**C**	**O**
Emeya overview	**M**	**C**	**C**	**O**	**C**
Evija overview	**B**	**S**	**B**	**M**	**M**
Compare models	**C**	**M**	**B**	**M**	**S**
Model selector (guided quiz)	**M**	**O**	**O**	**B**	**B**
Configure your Lotus	**S**	**B**	**M**	**O**	**M**
Prices & offers	**M**	**O**	**S**	**B**	**M**
Available cars	**M**	**C**	**O**	**S**	**S**
Book a test drive	**M**	**C**	**C**	**B**	**C**
Find a Lotus Centre	**B**	**C**	**O**	**C**	**B**
Lotus Charging	**M**	**B**	**B**	**O**	**M**
Lotus Connect app	**O**	**S**	**M**	**C**	**C**
Handbooks & manuals	**O**	**O**	**O**	**B**	**O**
Roadside assistance	**C**	**B**	**S**	**S**	**S**
Contact us	**S**	**M**	**S**	**M**	**B**
Heritage & motorsport	**O**	**C**	**B**	**C**	**S**

Table 1 - Every placement decision, P1–P5 (Respondents 4–8).

Agreement at a glance

The same 100 decisions, visualized. Chart 1 ranks each card by its highest agreement; chart 2 shows the full spread behind those numbers.

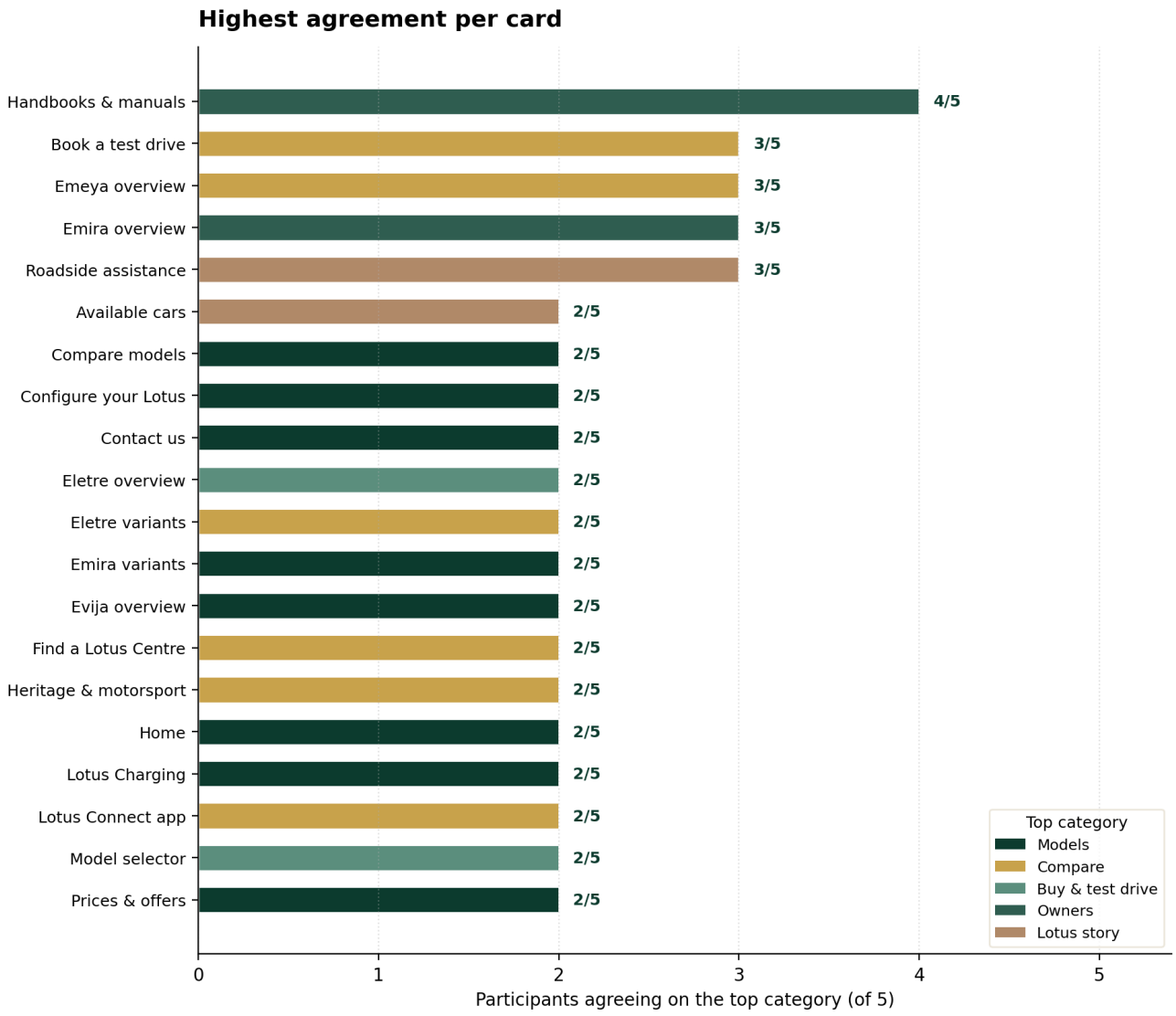


Chart 1 - Highest agreement per card (n=5), colored by the winning category.

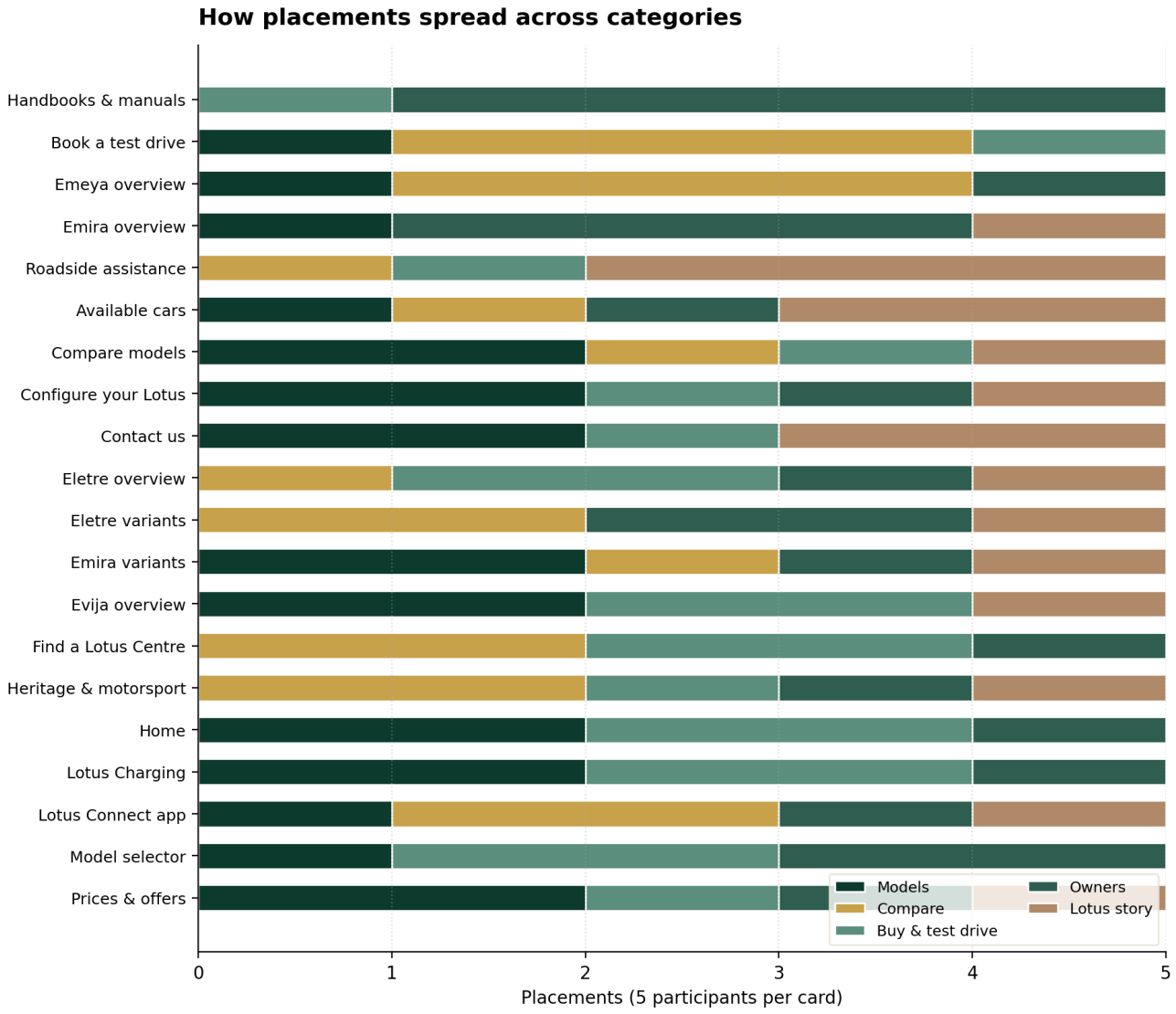


Chart 2 - How the 5 placements for each card spread across the categories.



Inside the Emira - model pages like these scattered across categories in the sorts.

07 · ANALYSIS

Agreement summary

0/20	cards reached unanimous agreement
4/5	best agreement: Handbooks & manuals → Owners
4	cards at 3/5: Emira overview, Emeya overview, Book a test drive, Roadside assistance
15	cards peaked at 2/5, scattering across 3–4 categories

50–86 second completions suggest fast, low-deliberation sorting; treat findings as directional.



A Lotus Elise at sunset - with 0 of 20 cards unanimous, the findings point a direction, not a destination.

What the patterns show

1. Ownership cohered best. Handbooks & manuals at 4/5 **Owners** is the clearest consensus in the dataset; ownership-support pages grouped better than any other set.

2. Model pages scattered. *Emira overview* at 3/5 **Owners** is hard to defend as a real mental model - likely a rushing artifact. The Models grouping is retained from the content inventory; retest recommended.

3. Compare was not understood. The *Compare models* card itself reached **Compare** only 1/5. Comparison tools may belong inside model pages rather than as a standalone category.

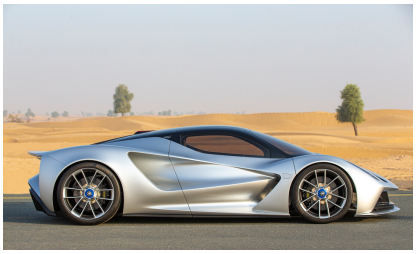
4. Purchase pages never settled. *Configure your Lotus*, *Prices & offers* and *Available cars* peaked at 2/5 across three or four categories - step labels need stronger scent.

5. Contact us → global. Split 2 **Models** / 2 **Lotus story** / 1 **Buy & test drive**: no clear home, so it becomes a global header/footer utility.

6. Home → site root. Split 2 **Models** / 2 **Buy & test drive** / 1 **Owners**: it is the site root; the split is a forced-choice artifact.







The Eletre, Emeya and Evija - model pages scattered across categories in the sorts.

09 · DECISIONS

From findings to information architecture

Decision rules

Preserve clear consensus - *Handbooks & manuals* (4/5 Owners) stays.

Investigate splits - 3/5 placements earn cross-links; 2/5-or-lower splits are noted, not acted on alone.

Separate global utilities - Home is the site root; Contact us goes global.

Avoid overclaiming - five fast sorts are directional only.

Triangulate - every decision checked against Assignment 1.

Connection to Assignment 1

The **ownership hub** (Assignment 1 priority) is **supported** - *Handbooks & manuals* at 4/5 is the clearest win in the dataset.

Compare-before-configuring (Assignment 1 priority) is **challenged** - *Compare models* reached Compare only 1/5; consider embedding comparison inside model pages.

The **visible purchase journey** (Assignment 1 priority) **needs work** - purchase-action cards scattered; step labels need stronger scent.

“Ownership-support pages produced the only real consensus, while model, comparison, and purchase pages scattered - partly a labeling problem, partly fast sessions. The proposed structure survives as a working hypothesis, with global utilities fixed, cross-links added, and Compare flagged for rethinking.”



Lotus motorsport heritage - the heart of the Lotus story category.

10 · RECOMMENDATIONS

Action plan

Each recommendation carries a priority, the expected benefit, the risk of ignoring it, a timeline, and a measurable success criterion.

HIGH

Anchor the Owners hub on Handbooks & manuals

Action: Keep the 4/5 placement; group charging, the app, manuals and assistance under Owners.

Expected benefit: Builds on the only user-validated grouping in the dataset.

Risk if ignored: Diluting the single consensus the study produced.

Timeline: Now - IA v1.

Success metric: Tree-test findability ≥ 80% for Handbooks & manuals.

HIGH

Make Contact us a global utility

Action: Place it in the header/footer; remove it from category candidates.

Expected benefit: Ends the 2/2/1 split across Models, Lotus story and Buy & test drive.

Risk if ignored: Users hunting for contact inside categories.

Timeline: Now - IA v1.

Success metric: Contact is findable in the tree test without category hunting.

MEDIUM

Add cross-links for split cards

Action: Emeya overview ↔ Compare; Book a test drive ↔ Compare; Find a Lotus Centre ↔ Compare and Buy & test drive; Lotus Charging ↔ Models and Buy & test drive; note Roadside assistance under Lotus story.

Expected benefit: Serves the minority mental models instead of only the plurality.

Risk if ignored: Dead ends for the ~40% of users who expected the other home.

Timeline: IA v1.

Success metric: Cross-link use observed in the usability test (Assignment 5).

MEDIUM

Rethink Compare; relabel Model selector

Action: Prototype comparison inside model pages versus a standalone section and test both; rename the quiz card “Help me choose a Lotus”.

Expected benefit: Fixes the category that failed its own test (Compare models → Compare only 1/5).

Risk if ignored: Building a section users do not recognize as a destination.

Timeline: Before build.

Success metric: On retest, Compare models reaches Compare ≥ 3/5 - or the section is removed.

MEDIUM

Rewrite purchase-step labels with stronger scent

Action: User-test new labels for Configure your Lotus, Prices & offers and Available cars.

Expected benefit: Unblocks the buy journey, the least-settled part of the IA.

Risk if ignored: Drop-off in the configurator funnel from misfiled expectations.

Timeline: Before build.

Success metric: Purchase cards reach 3/5 agreement on retest.

LOW

Retest with slower, deliberate task framing

Action: Rerun the closed sort instructing participants to take their time; follow with the tree test (Assignment 3).

Expected benefit: Confirms or overturns these directional findings with cleaner data.

Risk if ignored: Designing the final IA on noisy, rushed data.

Timeline: With Assignment 3 (Nov 11).

Success metric: Agreement distribution shifts upward vs. this study.

11 · SITEMAP

Proposed structure - 30 pages

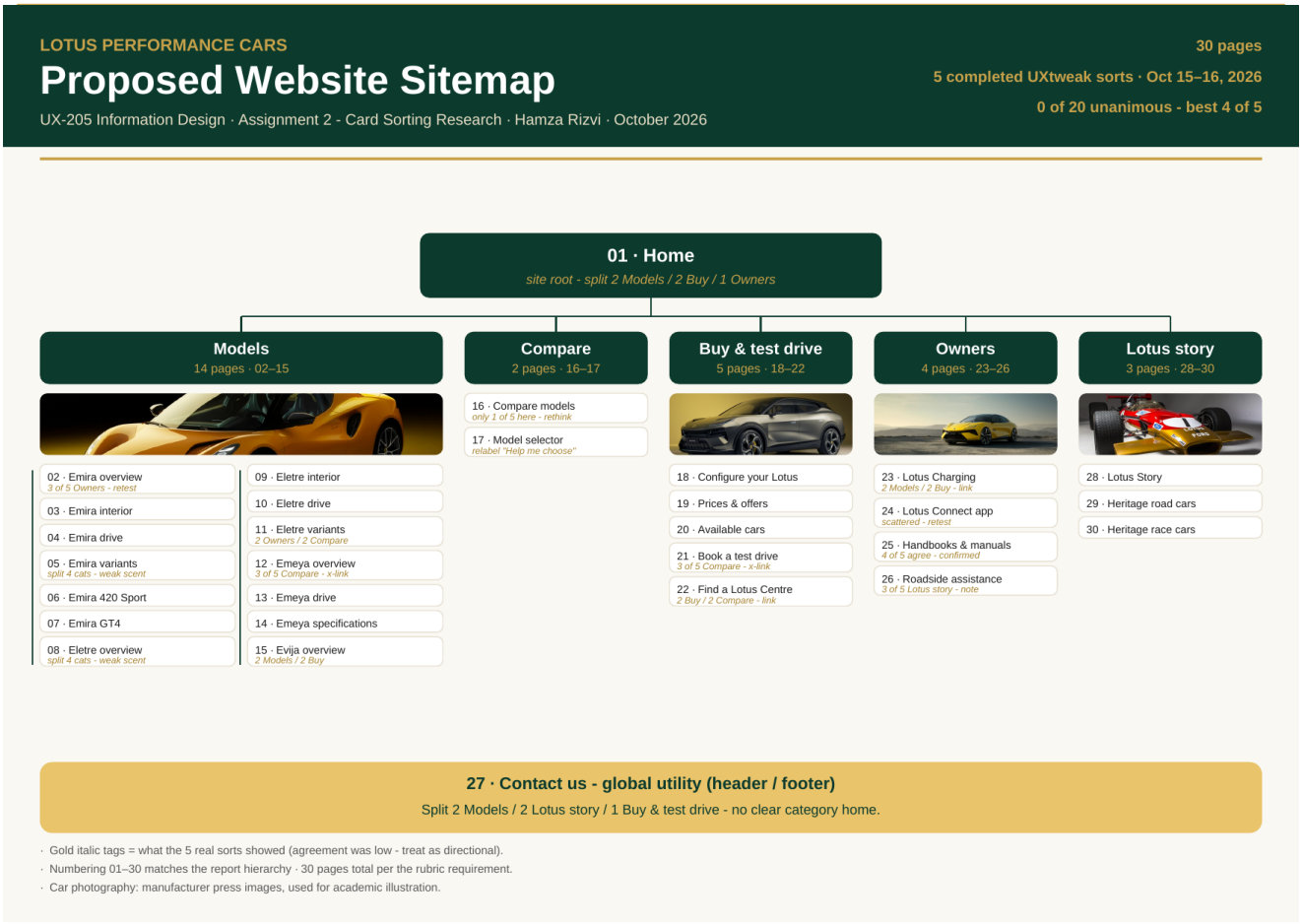


Figure 7 - Proposed sitemap: 30 pages across Models, Compare, Buy & test drive, Owners and Lotus story, with Contact us as a global utility. Gold tags show what the 5 real sorts found.

12 · WRAP-UP

Checklist, disclosure, sources

Completion checklist

- ✓ Card set, categories, and methodology documented.
- ✓ Setup screenshots captured and captioned.
- ✓ Live study link included.
- ✓ Five completed sorts obtained with participant evidence.
- ✓ Placement matrix recorded (100 decisions) and verified.
- ✓ Agreement analysis completed from real data.
- ✓ Assignment 1 connection documented.
- ✓ Sitemap updated from findings (30 pages).
- ✓ Report and sitemap exported as PDF.

Generative AI disclosure

Generative AI was used to brainstorm the report structure, organize study documentation, compute agreement tallies from the placement data, and create an editable writing framework. All participant data comes from the five completed UXtweak sessions recorded October 15–16, 2026; screenshots are unaltered captures. The student remains responsible for verifying the data, analysis, interpretation, citations, and submission.

Sources

[1] Nielsen Norman Group, “Card Sorting: Uncover Users’ Mental Models for Better Information Architecture.”

[2] UXtweak, “Types of Card Sorting.”

[3] UXtweak, “Online Card Sorting Tool.”

UX-205 Assignment 2 outline and rubric (MyLearningSpace); Assignment 1 competitor analysis (McLaren vs. Porsche) and content inventory.

Study link: study.uxtweak.com/cardsort/pEO55WnoaI6cotMVRKNq2

Car photography: manufacturer press images via automotive media outlets, used for academic illustration.



The Evija hypercar - the flagship of the Lotus story.